Laura Sità

Research Assistant

About me

I am a **researcher fellow** in psychology at the Department of General Psychology (DPG, University of Padova), working on the project 'Linking personality and daily stress: an intensive ecological assessment of psychological and physiological responses (STRATYS)'. Within this project, I am responsible for supporting participant recruitment and screening, coordinating data collection and analyses. I am also a member of the interdisciplinary research group Psicostat, where I am responsible for managing social media and coordinating email communications. (https://psicostat.dpss.psy.unipd.it/).

Education

Oct. 2022 - Dec. 2024 **MSc in Neuroscience and Neuropsychological Rehabilitation**, *University of Padova*, Padova, Italy.

- Thesis: Improving the Interpretation of Effect Sizes through Modeling and Simulation
- Supervisor: Gianmarco Altoè
- Co-Supervisor: Daniël Lakens
- Grade: 110/110 cum Laude

Oct. 2019 - Jul. 2022 **BSc in Cognitive and Psychobiological Sciences**, *University of Padova*, Padova, Italy.

- Thesis: Causal Inference using Propensity Score Techniques: an Analysis of the SHARE Database
- Supervisor: Massimo Nucci
- Co-Supervisor: Paolo Girardi
- Grade: 110/110 cum Laude

Research Experience

Mar. 2026 - Present **Research Assistant**, *University of Padova*, Padova, Italy.

- Project 'Linking personality and daily stress: an intensive ecological assessment of psychological and physiological responses (STRATYS)', focused on investigating how personality traits shape psychological and physiological responses to daily stress
- P.I.: Enrico Toffalini, Carola Dell'Acqua

Dec. 2025 - Mar. 2026 **Research Assistant**, *University of Padova*, Padova, Italy.

- Project 'Systematic Coding of Studies on Statistical Methods', focused on evaluating how interaction tests and link functions are applied in psychological research
- P.I.: Enrico Toffalini

University of Padova, via Venezia 8, Padova (Italy)
+39 3406048196 • laura.sita@studenti.unipd.it • *laura-sita*
sitalaura • *laurasit1*

May 2025 - Present **Research Assistant**, *University of Padova*, Padova, Italy.
- Systematic review on the role of working memory in the link between math anxiety and math performance
- P.I.: Sara Caviola

Feb. 2025 - June 2025 **Research Assistant**, *University of Padova*, Padova, Italy.
- Project 'Promotion of Well-being throughout the Life Cycle' aimed to promote Open Science practices and to contribute to the design of a Methodological Review Board
- P.I.: Gianmarco Altoè

Feb. 2024 - Jul. 2024 **Curricular Internship**, *Eindhoven University of Technology*, Eindhoven, The Netherlands.
- Research project about approach and interpretation of the effect size
- Supervisor: Daniël Lakens

Oct. 2021 - Feb. 2022 **Curricular Internship**, *University of Padova*, Padova, Italy.
- Research project about causal inference, focusing on the application of propensity score techniques
- Supervisor: Paolo Girardi

Awards & Grants

Dec. 2025 - Present **Scholarship**, *University of Padova.*
- Support for the activities planned within a project on the systematic coding of scientific articles, with specific focus on interaction tests and link functions

Jan. 2025 - June 2025 **Scholarship**, *University of Padova.*
- Support for the organization of activities planned within the Promotion of Well-being throughout the Life Cycle Project dedicated to Open Science

Feb. 2024 - Jul. 2024 **Scholarship**, *University of Padova.*
- Erasmus plus for Traineeships (400 euro/month + integrations) at Eindhoven University of Technology (NL)

Training

08-10 June 2025 **Replicability Crisis in Science**, *University of Padova.*
- Seminar on replicability and strategies to enhance scientific reliability, held in collaboration with lecturers from Harvard University and Northeastern University
- The course included lectures and workshops and took place over three days

03-06 June 2025 **Basics of Python for Data Science**, *University of Padova.*
- In-person course designed to provide foundational Python programming skills for data manipulation, visualization and statistical analysis in psychological research
- The course was held over four days, for a total of 10 hours

26-31 May 2025 **Beyond classical p-values**, *University of Trento.*
- Summer School on innovative approaches to inferential analyses, including statistical permutation tests, advanced network psychometrics and machine learning techniques from artificial intelligence

27-30 Jan. 2025 **Introduction to (Bayesian) Hypothesis Evaluation**, *Utrecht University.*
- e-learning Summer School course in Bayesian Hypothesis Evaluation

Nov. 2023 - Present **Hands-on Workshops on data analysis**, *University of Padova.*
- Attendance of workshops about statistical topics and how to conduct the analysis of real data sets
- Workshops last one hour and take place twice a month

Oct. 2023 - Present **Psicostat meetings**, *University of Padova.*
- Attendance of online meetings, organized by an interdisciplinary research group working in areas related to quantitative psychology, psychometrics, psychological testing and statistics
- Meetings last one hour and take place twice a month

Programming Languages

- **R/RStudio (Proficient):** Data handling, visualization, statistical analysis, simulations, modeling
- **Python (Basic):** Data handling, control structures, functions, basic plotting

Academic Experience

Organizational Activities

Science is Open: research meets citizens (Padova, Italy – 14 November 2025): Member of the organizing team. The event, open to the general public and hosted by the Department of Developmental and Social Psychology at the University of Padova, aimed to foster a dialogue between researchers and citizens about what it means to do science today. Through interactive discussions and expert panels, the initiative explored key issues in Open Science, such as transparency, reproducibility and public engagement. The program was designed to bridge different perspectives on science, encouraging mutual understanding and long-term collaboration between academia and society. The initiative is part of the 2024 Third Mission project funded by the University of Padova.

Round Table on the setup of a Methodological Review Board for Psychological Research (Padova, Italy – 27 June 2025): Member of the organizing team. The event was held at the University of Padova and was open to all researchers affiliated with the School of Psychology. It focused on the development of a Methodological Review Board (MRB) to support Open Science practices in psychology. The program included a presentation of the MRB project, the results of an internal survey on research practices, and an open discussion with scholars and institutional representatives. The initiative was part of the 2024 Third Mission project funded by the University of Padova. (https://methodological-review-board.github.io)

International Winter School - The 4 Ms: Meta-research, Measurement, Multi-lab, and Multiverse data analysis in Behavioral Sciences (Padova, Italy – 17-21 February 2025): Member of the organizing team. The Winter School aims to address the methodological challenges in behavioral sciences, which impact theory, measurement, and data analysis. Its main purpose is to introduce attendees to advancements in meta-research, providing both theoretical insights and practical tools to conduct rigorous research. Additionally, it aims to foster collaborative networks by enabling attendees to discuss their ongoing projects with teachers and peers, facilitating new collaborations and the application of the presented tools. (https://winterschool4ms.dpg.unipd.it)

Lectures

Causal Inference with Observational Data (Padova, Italy – 26 March 2025). 1-hour presentation delivered to the "Memory and Learning" research group (Department of General Psychology, University of Padova), introducing key concepts of causal inference in psychology using observational data with a focus on Directed Acyclic Graphs (DAGs), confounding and collider bias and adjustment strategies including propensity score methods.

Workshops

Causal Inference with Observational Data (Padova, Italy – 27 March 2025). 1-hour Hands-on Workshop organized by the "Psicostat" research group (Department of Developmental Psychology and Socialization, University of Padova) and open to all interested researchers, introducing key concepts of causal inference in psychology using observational data with a focus on Directed Acyclic Graphs (DAGs), confounding and collider bias and adjustment strategies including propensity score methods.

Research Groups Membership

Psicostat. I am a member of Psicostat, an interdisciplinary research group specialized in quantitative psychology, psychometrics, psychological testing and statistics. (2025 - Present) (https://psicostat.dpss.psy.unipd.it/pages/people)

Publications

Published Articles

Sità L., Caserotti, M., Zamparini, M., Lotto, L., de Girolamo, G. & Girardi, P. (2024). Impact of COVID-19 vaccination on preventive behavior: The importance of confounder adjustment in observational studies. *PloS one, 19(11)*, e0313117.

Conferences

Oral Presentations

Sità L., Calderan M., Feraco T., Gambarota F., Toffalini E. Are we getting interactions wrong? The role of link functions in psychological research. Cognitive Science Arena (CSA). Brixen, 5-7 February 2026.

Perugini A., Gambarota F., Toffalini E., **Sità L.**, Lakens D., Pastore M., Finos L., Psicostat & Altoè, G. (2024). Critical effect size values and why to report them. Oral presentation at the National Congress of the Italian Association of Psychology (AIP) – Developmental and Educational Psychology Section. Cagliari, 19–21 September 2024.

Sità L.. How to think about and model effect sizes. Invited presentation for Psicostat. Padova, 17 May 2024.

Poster Presentations

Calderan M., Gambarota F., **Sità L.**, Feraco T., Toffalini E. (2026). Are we getting interactions wrong? The role of link functions in psychological research. European Mathematical Psychology Group Meeting (EMPG 2026). Innsbruck, 7–9 September 2026.

Padova, September 9, 2026

Laura Sità



University of Padova, via Venezia 8, Padova (Italy)
+39 3406048196 • laura.sita@studenti.unipd.it • *laura-sita*
sitalaura • *laurasit1*